

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Problem 3. Niuean (20 marks)

Niuean is a Polynesian language spoken by nearly 8,000 people around the world. It is the official language of Niue, although most of its speakers live in other countries, such as New Zealand.

Below are some sentences in Niuean with a possible translation into English. Note that **ā** and **ū** are long vowels, and that **g** represents the *ng* sound in “sing”.



Niuean	English
Kua kai noa a au.	<i>I have only eaten.</i>
Kua fai fakatino foki ne tā e ia.	<i>There have also been pictures that he drew.</i>
Muhu moa tūmau.	<i>There are always plenty of birds.</i>
Ne fai faiaoga e kāmuta.	<i>The carpenter had teachers.</i>
Kua kitia e ia a au.	<i>He has seen me.</i>
To kai he moa ka holoholo e au e ika.	<i>The bird that I will wash will eat the fish.</i>
Ne totou a Sione.	<i>Sione read.</i>
Tā tūmau e Mele e fakatino.	<i>Mele is always drawing the picture.</i>
Ne kai e ika ne takafaga he tama	<i>The fish that the child caught ate</i>
To holoholo foki he tama e vaka ne tā he kāmuta.	<i>The child will also wash the canoe that the carpenter built.</i>
To muhu ika a Mele.	<i>Mele will have plenty of fish.</i>
Muhu tama foki e faiaoga ka kitia he moa.	<i>The teacher also has plenty of children that the bird will see.</i>
Fai vaka a Sione ne holoholo e au.	<i>Sione has canoes that I washed.</i>

3.1) On your answer sheet, translate the following sentences into English. If there are multiple possible translations, give only one.

- Fai moa noa.**
- Kua holoholo foki he faiaoga ne takafaga e au a ia.**
- To muhu vaka e tama ne kitia he moa ka holoholo e Sione.**

3.2) Translate the following sentences into Niuean.

- He will also read.*
- Sione has only had fish that the teacher will eat.*
- The teacher that Mele saw built the canoe.*
- There have always been plenty of carpenters.*

3.3) Explain your solution.